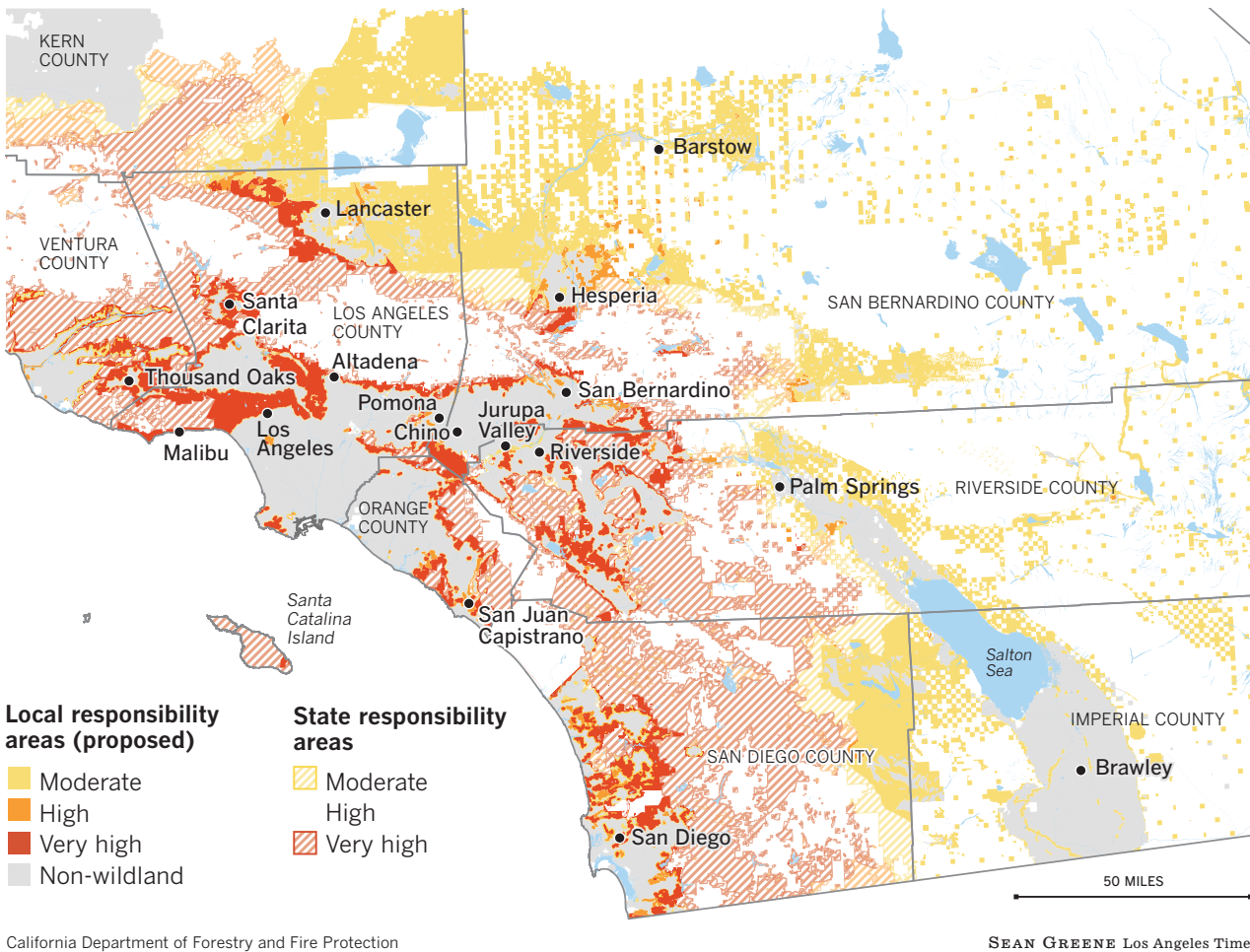


New fire hazard zones for Los Angeles and Southern California



California Department of Forestry and Fire Protection
SEAN GREENE Los Angeles Times

New fire maps increase SoCal hazard zones by 3.5 million acres

Agency’s redrawn boundaries increase amount of land in the highest severity areas by 30% in the county.

By Noah Haggerty and Sean Greene

The California Department of Forestry and Fire Protection released updated fire hazard severity zone maps for Los Angeles County for the first time in over a decade on Monday, adding more than 440,000 acres to the county’s hazard zones, including a 30% increase in acres zoned in the highest severity rating.

The release — which includes all of Southern California and marks the end of the agency’s two-month, statewide rollout — sets off a roughly five-month clock for the city and county of L.A. to receive public input, make

adjustments and begin enforcing heightened fire-safety regulations within the new zones.

The new Cal Fire maps are only for areas where local fire departments, like the Los Angeles Fire Department and Los Angeles County Fire Department, are responsible for responding to blazes. Previously, Cal Fire only mapped the highest severity rating, “very high,” for these local responsibility areas. The new maps include Cal Fire’s “moderate” and “high” zones as well.

Cal Fire most recently updated all three zones for the areas where the state responds to fires in September 2023. However, the last time the agency updated its maps for areas where local fire departments are responsible was in 2011.

The city of L.A. saw its acreage in the “very high” zone increase by 7%. The addition of the new “moderate” and “high” zones led to the

[See Maps, A8]

With billions at stake, lawyers pour into fire-scarred Altadena

In person and on Zoom calls, ‘victim advocates’ are ready and available

By Matt Hamilton

She is the nation’s most famous legal secretary, whose real-life advocacy on toxic groundwater was portrayed by Julia Roberts to Oscar-winning acclaim.

He is the most recognizable civil rights attorney of his generation, winning millions of dollars for Black and brown families whose loved ones — George Floyd, Breonna Taylor, Michael Brown — died at the hands of police and sparked a global outcry.

Both Erin Brockovich and Benjamin Crump have



CHRISTINA HOUSE Los Angeles Times
ANNE ANDREWS, an Orange County lawyer, talks at a town hall in Pasadena for Eaton fire victims.

descended on the charred ruins of Altadena as the aftermath of the deadly Eaton fire shifts to the courthouse, with Southern California Edison in the crosshairs.

And they’re not alone. In churches, community centers and hotel conference rooms, on private Zoom calls and at public food giveaways, lawyers and their swarm of assistants, marketers and so-called victim advocates are ready and available. Mailboxes have filled up with printed fliers inviting Altadenans to town

[See Advocates, A6]

War plans shared in text with journalist

Top national security officials gave details of upcoming military strikes in Yemen.

By Tara Copp, Aamer Madhani and Eric Tucker

WASHINGTON — Top national security officials for President Trump, including his Defense secretary, texted war plans for upcoming military strikes in Yemen to a group chat in a secure messaging app that included the Atlantic’s top editor, the magazine reported in a story posted online Monday.

The National Security Council said the text chain “appears to be authentic.”

Trump told reporters he was not aware that the sensitive information had been shared, 2½ hours after it was reported.

The material in the text chain “contained operational details of forthcoming strikes on Iran-backed Houthi rebels in Yemen, including information about targets, weapons the U.S. would be deploying, and attack sequencing,” Editor in Chief Jeffrey Goldberg reported.

It was not immediately clear whether the specifics of the military operation were classified, but they often are and at the very least are kept secure to protect service members and operational security. The U.S. has conducted

[See War plans, A5]

COLUMN ONE

A homie anchor for Inland Empire

In a region losing news resources, Ahmed Bellozo’s videos, with bits of Spanish and prison slang, are resonating on social media.

By Daniel Eduardo Hernandez

In prison and seemingly unable to escape a destructive cycle that began when he was a child, Ahmed Bellozo spent hours watching investigative journalism shows, educational documentaries and Huell Howser’s homespun travelogue, “California’s Gold.” It was a way, he said, to distract from his pain.

Years later, out of prison and wanting a drastic change in his life, Bellozo turned to those shows for inspiration as he reinvented himself on social media as the star of “On the Tira” — a video series that’s part showcase of local landmarks, part investigative journalism and part hyperlocal news about fires and car accidents across the Inland Empire communities he’s lived in for most of his life.

Armed with a cellphone, a blinged-out toy microphone and a large gold chain bearing his logo, Bellozo films himself delivering the news — at times admitting he’s unsure of the facts — with his memora-

[See News, A10]



MARK BOSTER For De Los
AHMED BELLOZO’S “On the Tira” videos showcase area landmarks, investigative journalism and hyperlocal news.

An O.C. couple’s sudden deportation sends shock waves

After living in the U.S. for decades with no criminal record, they are sent to Colombia.

By Ruben Vives

Nelson and Gladys Gonzalez lived in the United States illegally for decades, working hard and raising a family while regularly checking in with Immigration and Customs Enforcement as part of an agreement to re-

main in the country.

But when the Laguna Niguel couple showed up for a routine check-in on Feb. 21, they were detained and sent back to Colombia, according to the family’s GoFundMe page and a spokesperson for ICE.

The couple’s sudden deportation stunned their three adult daughters, who are American citizens.

“They have never broken the law, never missed an appointment and this sudden occurrence has left us in shock,” they wrote on the fundraising site. “This cruel and unjust situation has shattered our family emotionally and financially.”

The ICE spokesperson confirmed that the couple had been given a final order for removal, and that they had no criminal history.

Advocates say the cou-

[See O.C., A5]

USC takes on Mississippi State
Trojans’ second-round game ended after this edition’s deadline. Go to latimes.com/sports.

23andMe files for bankruptcy
Shares of the genetic firm sink after California issues a privacy warning. BUSINESS, A7

The joke is on President Trump
Conan O’Brien and his funny friends speak up at the Kennedy Center. ENTERTAINMENT, E1

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